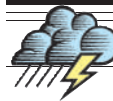


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T-storm 94/77 • Tomorrow: Heavy t-storm 93/76 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, JULY 26, 2025 • \$4

U.S. freeze on school funding is set to end

\$5B will be released after review for compliance with Trump priorities

BY JUSTINE MCDANIEL
AND LAURA MECKLER

The Trump administration plans to release more than \$5 billion in funding to public schools that it has withheld for nearly a month, a senior administration official said Friday, ending weeks of anxiety and uncertainty for school leaders who had said the freeze jeopardized programs and staffing for the upcoming academic year.

The government placed nearly \$7 billion in funding under review June 30, then released \$1.3 billion of it last week. The administration's review of the remaining funding has ended, the official said, speaking on the condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to speak on the record.

Rep. Don Bacon (R-Nebraska) confirmed the move on social media, saying that he pushed for the money to be released. "Exciting news to announce! All frozen education funding for the upcoming school year have been released," he wrote on X.

Lawmakers from both parties had lobbied to release the money, which funds six grant programs related to English-language-learning programs, teacher training, support for children of migrant workers and academic enrichment activities. The freeze was also being challenged in court by states and school districts.

States expected the funding to be released July 1, as normally happens each year. Instead, the

SEE FUNDING ON A2

Ghislaine Maxwell: Trump says he's not considering a pardon. **A7**



CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Men use nets to move tuna from a fishing vessel to a refrigerated container ship in the lagoon of Funafuti, Tuvalu's capital.

Threat to tuna endangers livelihoods

Pacific islands that depend on the fish are seeing climate change drive them away

BY MICHAEL E. MILLER
AND CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN

FUNAFUTI, TUVALU — Kauaka Petaia guided his motorboat out of Tuvalu's main lagoon at dawn and into the vast Pacific Ocean, where he and his nephew scanned the rolling horizon for signs of their country's most precious resource: tuna.

They searched for more than two hours before finally spotting seagulls circling in the distance. Petaia threw open the throttle as his nephew, Ranol Smoliner, tossed a hooked line into the water. Soon, the younger man felt the tug of a 25-pound yellowfin, which he pulled up and

bashed with a club. By morning's end, the pair had caught eight tuna — a haul far smaller than when Petaia's father taught him to fish 30 years earlier.

"We have to spend longer and go farther to get them," the 48-year-old said as the fishermen unloaded their catch.

"I'm not sure there will be any tuna left by the time I'm my uncle's age," added Smoliner, 22.

Tuna is a pillar of life in the Pacific, where for centuries people have braved the ocean to bring back yellowfin, skipjack, bigeye and albacore for their families.

In recent decades, as global de-

mand for tuna has soared, Pacific island nations including Tuvalu have propped up their struggling economies by selling licenses to allow international fishing companies to trawl their vast exclusive economic zones. These seas provide as much as one-third of the world's tuna supply.

But climate change is warming the world's oceans at an accelerating rate, threatening livelihoods.

Scientists predict that climate change will push tuna away from Pacific island nations and toward the high seas, where wealthier countries with large fishing fleets — China, Japan, South Korea and the United

SEE TUNA ON A10

Tiny motors? Tour de France hums with rumors.

New checks aim to keep race clean — and assure skeptical fans

BY KEVIN SIEFF

MUR-DE-BRETAGNE, FRANCE — After the world's best cyclists charged up the final climb in Stage 7 of the Tour de France, passing a roaring crowd at the finish line, a group of officials in black polo shirts darted toward their bikes.

The officials put red bracelets on the carbon frames. Their job was to conduct a little-known check in one of the world's most scandal-stained sports: The bikes were being inspected for tiny motors.

Eight bikes were wheeled to a black tent a few feet from the podium, the handlebar tape still wet with riders' sweat. One belonged to the winner of the stage, Tadej Pogacar. The other bikes belonged to riders whom cycling officials had targeted based on questionable performances or tips.

Twenty years after a doping scandal upended the sport, professional cycling is pursuing dual challenges of keeping the world's most famous cycling race honest and convincing a skeptical audience of the Tour's legitimacy. That's why Nicholas Raudenski, a former U.S. Department of Homeland Security investigator, was standing next to the finish line as officials escorted the bikes



PHOTOS BY JEANNE MERCIER/HANS LUCAS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Racers approach the finish line of Stage 7 of the Tour de France in Mur-de-Bretagne on July 11. Tadej Pogacar won the stage.



With scanners, inspectors can look inside a bike's frame to check for hidden motors. So far none have been found.

to an X-ray machine.

Raudenski was hired last year as the head of the global cycling federation's unit against technological fraud, a form of cheating known colloquially as "mechanical doping." If he caught anyone, it would send a shock through a sport in which athletes routinely do the superhuman. What if the reason cyclists were able to glide up the Pyrenees mountains was because they weren't pedaling unassisted?

Raudenski knew that only one professional cyclist had been caught competing with a hidden motor — a Belgian rider at the 2016 cyclo-cross world championships under-23 race. But the technology had improved dramatically since then. If he wasn't vigilant, Raudenski believed, the Tour could be consumed by riders propelled by tiny motors.

The cycling federation, known by its name in French, Union Cycliste Internationale (UCI), was also trying to send a message to its fans. Many had followed the growing online discourse suggesting that cycling was once again turning a blind eye to cheaters. Fans posted videos about how easy it had become to sneak miniature motors into bike frames; they analyzed race footage that allegedly showed superhuman performances; they quoted former cyclists who swore the sport was still corrupt.

"If people are watching the Tour at home, or they're out here braving the heat, they need to be

SEE ENGINES ON A18

They're rich, anti-Trump and galled by their big tax cut

BY JEFF STEIN

Kimberly Hoover has been to most Michelin-star restaurants on the East and West coasts. She and her wife, multimillionaires from their real estate firms, own homes in or near New York City, Washington, Miami and Quebec. Their lives are filled with skiing, fine wine and long trips to Europe.

Hoover's accountant estimates that the new tax law that President Donald Trump signed this month will save her several million dollars over the next few years. While many Americans

might rejoice at that kind of windfall, Hoover worked hard to stop it from becoming a reality, arguing to lawmakers that she has more money than she needs.

"At some point, it starts to feel wrong. It starts to feel excessive. It starts to feel somehow inappropriate. And at some point, it just doesn't feel good," said Hoover, who spoke while on break from a sapphire literature conference she helps sponsor in Albany. "Imbalanced is really not good for any-

SEE RICH ON A5

Spending deal: Democrats warn of clawbacks' impact on talks. **A5**

A toddler starved to death in D.C. Why wasn't she saved?

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN

Daniel Skinner felt a grating sense of unease as he sent another text to Ebony Washington, the mother of their 20-month-old daughter.

"At least let me know you and Kemy is ok," he wrote in early January.

No answer. Almost two weeks earlier, Skinner, 37, had sent another message, offering to take Kemy to his mother's house at Christmas, to give Ebony a respite from solo parent-

ing. He got no response that day and none the next, when he texted, "Merry Christmas." Nor when he knocked on her door and phoned again and again.

"Ebony what's going on," he texted, this time on Jan. 15.

Three days later, in a Northwest Washington high-rise, Skinner's mother, Kineta Johnson, and two police officers walked to Ebony's apartment at the end of a long, carpeted hallway. When a building worker opened the door for them, Johnson would say later,

SEE TODDLER ON A6

IN THE NEWS

Prisoner swap A deal brokered at the behest of Trump sent to the U.S. a man whom a Venezuelan court convicted of murder, roiling allies and dividing the State Department. **A4**

Lawyer sues government A former federal prosecutor who handled Jan. 6 cases and two others filed suit over their terminations. **B13**

THE NATION
Relief and regret followed the scrapping of a coastal restoration project in Louisiana. **A3**
The U.S. and Qatar are finalizing a deal for a Boeing 747 to be used as Air Force One. **A4**

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As Kenya's protests intensified, two friends bled on opposite sides of a demonstration. **A8**
The death of a Russian minister tells the country's political elite it's no longer protected. **A9**

THE ECONOMY
An app billing itself as a hub for women to check a potential date's history led to privacy concerns among men. **A13**
Apple's newest version of iOS features an updated interface and improved phone and camera apps, but it needs some fine-tuning. **A14**

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Public broadcasters are mulling their options to fill the gap caused by the cut of federal funding. **B1**

SPORTS
Frances Tiafoe bows out at the DC Open, falling to Ben Shelton in the quarterfinals in straight sets. **B7**

THE REGION
Parents discovered students' private records and thousands of dollars' worth of equipment in a Hyattsville school set to be demolished. **B13**
Transgender policies in five Virginia school districts violate Title IX, the U.S. Education Department said. **B13**

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